

## *Find Your Fuel*

Years ago, when I first showed an interest in becoming a speaker and author, a friend pulled me aside. He said something like, “Listen, Hogan, I just don’t think you can do it. I don’t think you have what it takes to drive a brand, write books, and own a national stage.” Now, an experience like that would shut a lot of people down. They’d go home and convince themselves that their friend was right, and they’d never even try to accomplish their big goal. Not me. To be honest, I got mad. *Real* mad. Instead of shutting me down, that experience fired me up. If there was any doubt in my mind before then, it was gone after that conversation. I went home and thought about it for a while. Ultimately, I decided, *He doesn't think I can do it. I'm going to prove him wrong.* And I did. Several years later, a group of us got together to watch a football game at his house, and he pulled me aside. He apologized for what he had said that day, and he admitted that I’d blown past all his expectations. I love this guy, and I had long since forgiven him. However, even though his apology wasn’t necessary, I’ll admit that it was good to hear.

That experience was one of many times in my life when someone sized me up and tried to tell me no. The problem with that kind of *no* is that it’s not really about the circumstances or the opportunities. Instead, that kind of *no* is about *me*. It’s not someone saying, “It can’t be done”—it’s someone saying, “*You* can’t do it.” There’s a huge difference in those two statements. I don’t want to sound childish, but when someone tells me I can’t do something, it just adds fuel to my fire. It drives me forward and kicks my efforts into an even higher gear. If you want to push me further, just tell me I can’t do something. From that point on, it’ll be my goal to make you eat those words. I don’t just want to prove the other person wrong, though; I want to prove that *I’m* right! That’s what I call “looking for the chips.” I never want to be weighed down by a chip on my shoulder, so I’m constantly looking for them, taking them off my back, and throwing them in